

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ 6 5 2
♦ Q T 5 2
♣ K Q 9 3

♠ A T
♥ A K Q J 9
♦ K 4 3
♣ 7 5 2



♠ K Q J 7 4
♥ T 3
♦ J 8 7
♣ J T 4

♠ 9 8 6 2
♥ 8 7 4
♦ A 9 6
♣ A 8 6

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♣	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North

HELP SUIT GAME TRY. Partner has 8 points and the ♣A and decides that is enough to bid game.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠K.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠K.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 2 : Total = 4

You win the ♠A and pull trumps in three rounds. You need to manufacture one winner and you can see right off the bat that it cannot be manufactured in ♦s or ♣s. However, you **CAN** set up the ♠8.

Lead the ♠T. East must win with his ♠J. Let's say he plays a ♣. Win with dummy's ♣A and play the ♠9, discarding a small ♣. East will take his ♠Q and cash a ♣ trick, but then must let you back in. You enter dummy with the ♦A and discard your ♦ loser on the good ♠8.

It is extra nice when the opponents hand you a contract.

You cannot make 10 tricks unless East's opening lead is a ♠.

Your first bid is easy, you say 1♥. But what do you say after partner's 2♥ response?

You have 18 points and partner has 6-10. Doing the math, you total 24-28.

You want to make a bid that will tell partner to bid game if he has 9-10, but will stop at 3♥ if he only has 6-7. Lots of players will bid 3♥ with this hand to make just that invitation. There's nothing wrong with that bid.

But there is an improvement. Bid 3♣ instead. Partner knows you aren't showing him a ♣ suit, why would you do that after agreeing on ♥s? What it means is "Partner I'm inviting you to bid the game if you have maximum, but if your decision is close decide based on ♣s, the suit I could use help in." It is called a

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A J 6 4

♥ 7 5

♦ A K 7 4 2

♣ 6 2

♠ T

♥ K 9 8 3

♦ Q J 9 5

♣ Q T 7 4



♠ K Q 9 8 7 5 2

♥ A 4

♦ 6 3

♣ A 8

♠ 3

♥ Q J T 6 2

♦ T 8

♣ K J 9 5 3

West	North	East	South
1♦	Pass	1♠	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♣	Pass
3♦	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♥	Pass	6♠	

All Pass

6♠ by East

you aren't bidding a ♣ suit, he knows you have already agreed on ♠s. He will take you to be showing first round control in ♣s, probably the ♣A.

Partner bids 3♦.

Partner's 3♦ is a control bid showing the ♦A. Do not even consider that he is trying to get back to ♦s, you both know that your suit is ♠s.

NOW you use Blackwood, knowing you are not in danger of losing two quick ♦s.

Partner replies 5♥, showing two Aces.

Your side has all the Aces but don't get greedy. Remember that partner made a minimum bid at his second turn. He couldn't have two Aces and three Kings.

So you bid the small slam.

East plays 6♠. South leads the ♥Q.

East plays 6♠. South leads the ♥Q.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 2

Too bad partner didn't have either ♥K or ♣K. But since he didn't you will just have to establish the ♦ suit.

You pull trumps in one round with your ♠K. Play ♦ A K, then ruff a ♦. if both defenders follow then both dummy's ♦s are good and you will make 7. However, it is more likely that ♦s will split 4-2, in which case you return to dummy with the ♠J and ruff the fourth ♦. Back to dummy with the ♠A and play the now-established ♦7, discarding either your ♥ or ♣ loser.

Establishing a long side suit in dummy is one of the basic ways to eliminate a loser.

In this hand you could not be defeated unless the ♦s split 5-1.

You don't quite have the strength for a jump-shift, and in any case sometimes it is better to proceed slowly. So you respond 1♠, knowing partner must bid again.

He does bid again, surprising you when he says 2♠.

All of a sudden your hand has become gigantic. Never mind points, you have only 5 possible losers in your hand and partner has opened the bidding. Surely he can take care of a few of them.

You want to try for slam. **DO NOT BID**

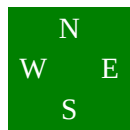
BLACKWOOD! With two quick losers in ♦s you would not know what to do if Partner showed only one Ace. You wouldn't know whether the defense could take the first two ♦ tricks or not. A better approach is to use a control bid.

So you bid 3♣. Partner will absolutely know that

Board 3
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ Q J T 6
 ♥ 8
 ♦ K J 9 4
 ♣ J T 8 5

♠ A K 4 3
 ♥ A 5 2
 ♦ A 7 6 2
 ♣ K 4



♠ 8 7 5
 ♥ 9 7 4
 ♦ Q T 5
 ♣ A Q 7 3

♠ 9 2
 ♥ K Q J T 6 3
 ♦ 8 3
 ♣ 9 6 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	4♥		2♥
All Pass			
4♥ by South			

Wow! Partner opens with a 2-bid and you have all of this?

Don't get carried away, it was a **WEAK** 2-bid. So even though you have 19 points partner has only 6-11. But even though it is possible that the total only comes to 25 you bid the game anyway, figuring that it will probably be at least 26.

North would play 4♥.

Click

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♠Q.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♠Q.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 3 : Total = 4

There are two ways to get rid of one of those ♣ losers. You can lead up to the ♣K, hoping that West holds ♣A, or you can ruff it in dummy.

Suppose you try to combine both chances. Win the ♠K, then play a small ♥ to your hand. Lead a ♣ and play dummy's ♣K. East takes the ♣A and plays another trump which you win in your hand. You play another ♣ but East wins this one also and leads another trump, removing dummy's last hope of ruffing a ♣. Down 1.

Instead you could give up on the idea of leading toward the ♣K and just lead a ♣ from dummy at trick 2. The defenders can win and lead a trump, but you play a second ♣. They win this also but even if they lead a trump you can still ruff your third ♣ in dummy and make the game.

You can see that playing a ♣ from dummy will guarantee the contract.

You can also see that leading a ♥ back to your hand at trick 2 is a bad idea.

But did you see there is another way to reach your hand? You could play ♠A then ruff a ♠. This runs the small risk that East started with a singleton ♠.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K J T 8 4
 ♥ A K 3 2
 ♦ 9 5
 ♣ A 6

♠ 7 5 3
 ♥ Q T 7 6
 ♦ K Q J
 ♣ Q T 8



♠ Q 9 2
 ♥ 8 5 4
 ♦ A 6 3
 ♣ 7 5 4 2

♠ A 6
 ♥ J 9
 ♦ T 8 7 4 2
 ♣ K J 9 3

West	North	East	South
1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠	Pass
3 ♦	Pass	3 ♠	
All Pass			

3 ♠ by West

West plays 3 ♠. North leads the ♦ K.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 5

The ♦ loser, the ♣ loser and the Ace of trumps are unavoidable. One ♥ loser is also unavoidable, but the second one can be ruffed in dummy. You cannot afford to play a single trump.

Win the ♦ A and play ♥ A, ♥ K, ♥ 2. The defenders will win this. If your ♥ 3 happened to set up then you won't have to ruff it, but more than likely the ♥ s split 4-2. The defenders may now take a ♦ winner, or they may lead ♠ A and another ♠. But they cannot stop you from ruffing your fourth ♥ with dummy's ♠ Q or ♠ 9.

The defenders may not lead trumps to try to stop your ruff.

In that case you must be sure to ruff the fourth ♥ with the ♠ Q or the ♠ 9. If South wants to over-ruff it will be with the ♠ A which you must lose anyway.

Look at what would have happened if you had led a trump at trick 2. South could have won the ♠ A and played another ♠. Then, when North took the third ♥ he could lead his last ♠ and dummy would have no trump to ruff the final ♥ with.

With 6 points you must respond. And with 3 ♠ s you can support partner's suit.

You respond 2 ♠ and partner bids 3 ♦.

Partner's 3 ♦ bid is a Help Suit Game Try. He is inviting you to bid game if you have a good 2 ♠ response, particularly if you can help him in ♦ s.

Although have the ♦ help you have a bare minimum response. So you return to 3 ♠ which partner passes.

East would play 3 ♠.

Click

West plays 3 ♠. North leads the ♦ K.